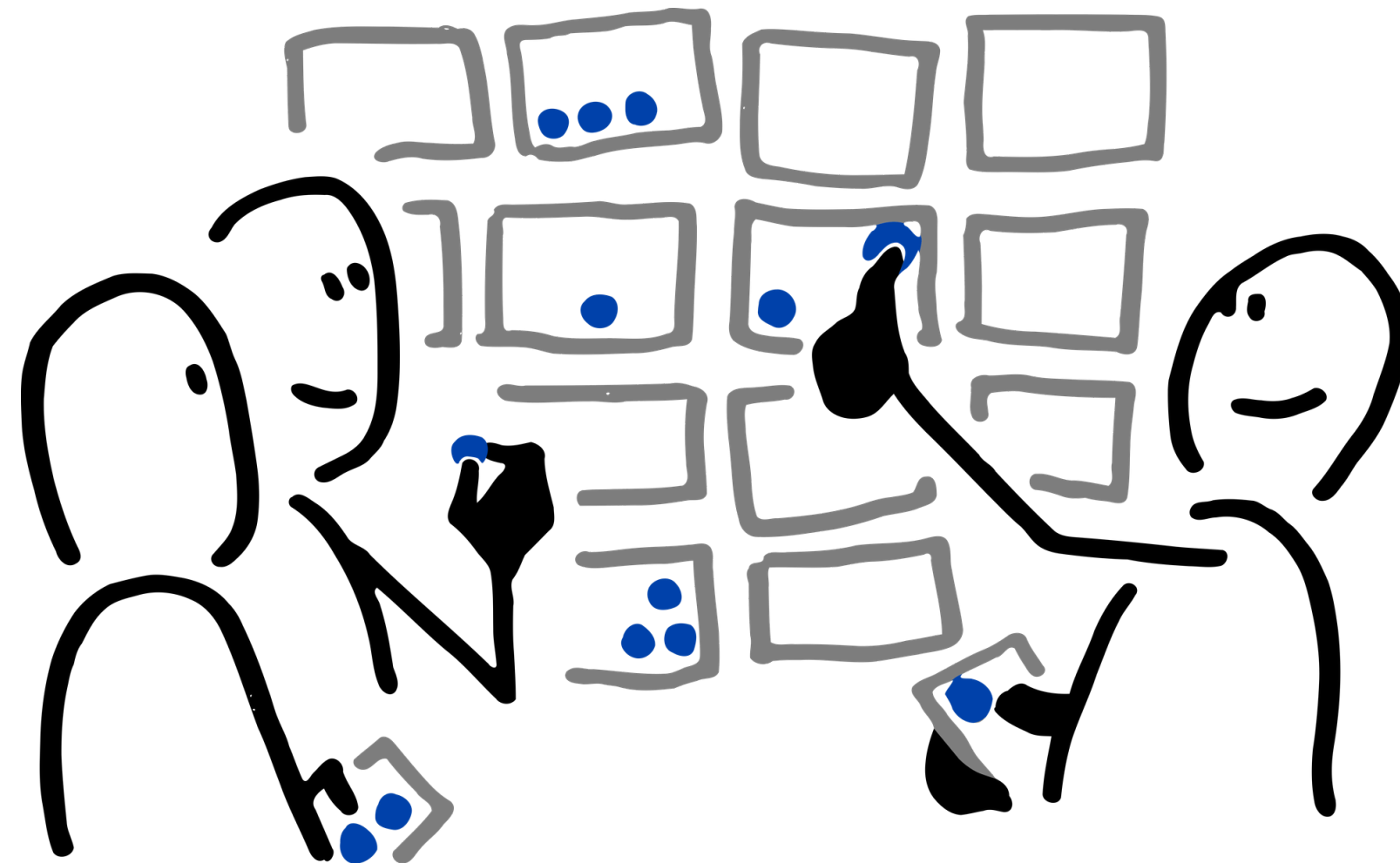


ViTally

A VITA SITE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

A CASE STUDY OF PCDC

Presented by: Cody Chi / Hailey Zheng / Jinyu Yang

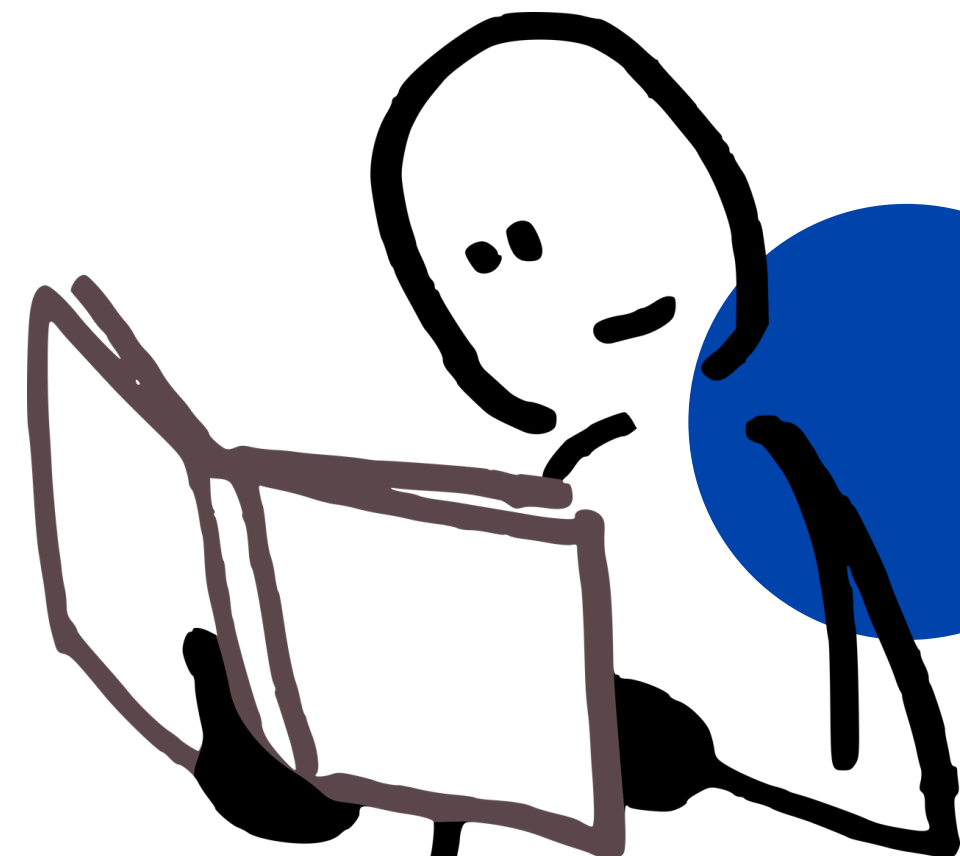


What is VITA?

VITA = Volunteer Income Tax Assistance, a community-based program supported by the IRS that trains volunteers to provide free tax preparation services to eligible taxpayers (low-to-moderate-income taxpayers, individuals with disabilities, and people with limited English proficiency). IRS provides limited grants to help with running the site based on the report and proposal.

What is PCDC?

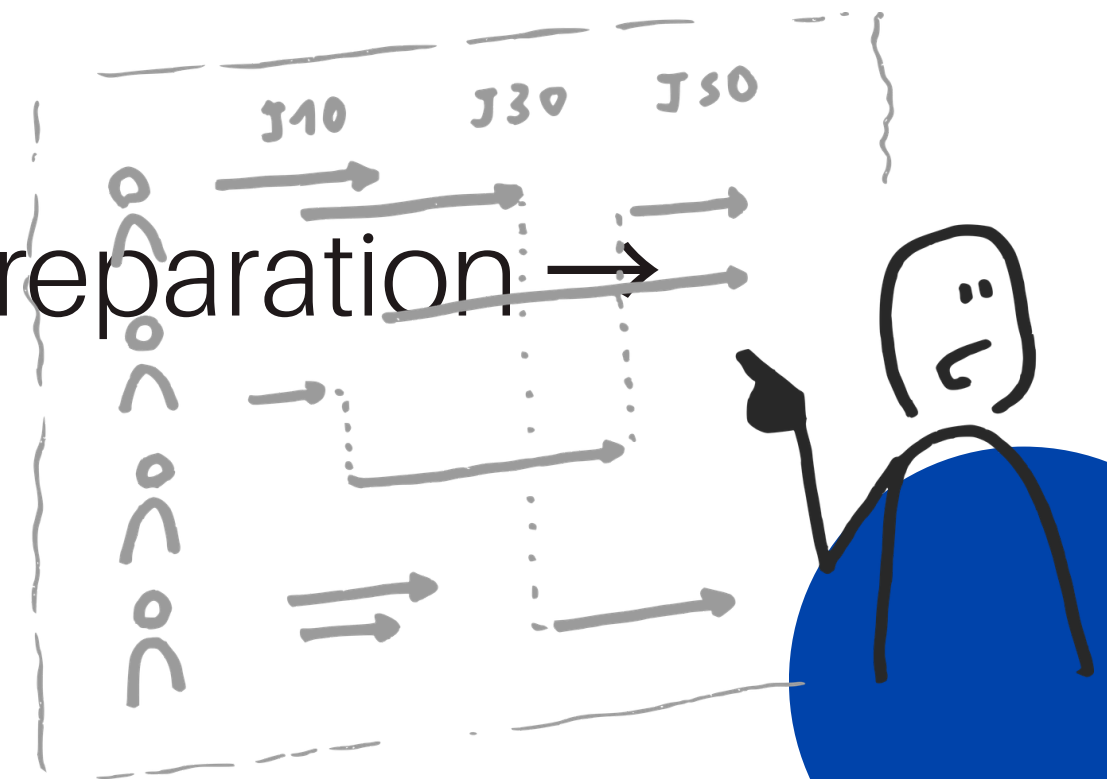
PCDC (Philadelphia Chinatown Development Corporation) is a Philadelphia-based nonprofit that has run a free VITA tax preparation program for its community for over 10 years — this is the real-world site we use as our case study.



CURRENT SITE SERVICE MODELS

Three ways to accepting requests

- **Same Day**
full on-site process, same-day service, held on 4–5 weekends
- **Drop-off**
client drops off in person on weekdays, volunteers work remotely, admin coordinates
- **Online**
fully remote — online submission → remote preparation →
Zoom identity verification → email delivery



Potential Problems (Based on Current Service Models)

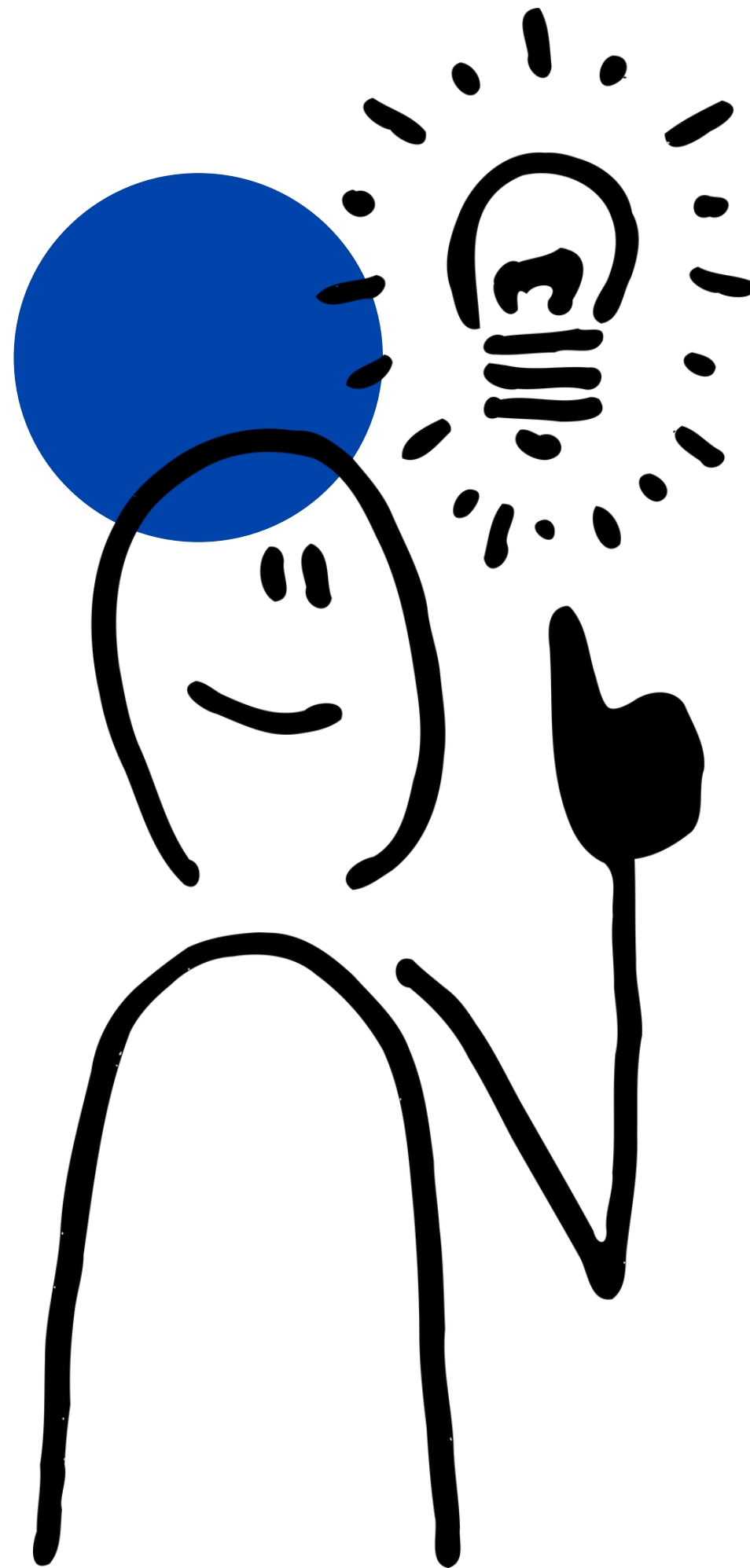
- **No centralized case tracking** across the three channels (status, documents, turnaround time)
- **No unified volunteer-matching system** — by availability, certification level, or language
- **Manual communication** (calls, emails) → added admin workload, delays, errors
- **No consolidated data** → limited visibility into demand, volunteer utilization, and bottlenecks
- Manual Document Intake & Data Entry
- Need for Greater Automation and Digital Document Processing



Potential Problems(Based on PCDC & VITA Background)

- **Volunteer-client imbalance:** ~20 active volunteers vs. 700+ requests
- **Limited & tightly stretched grant funding:** less than \$10/case when divided evenly, without accounting for operating costs or case complexity.
- **No data-driven case management:** no dedicated data role means limited ability to report impact and secure future grants.





WHAT'S MORE...

- **Ms. Xu (Case #619, TY2022-2025)**

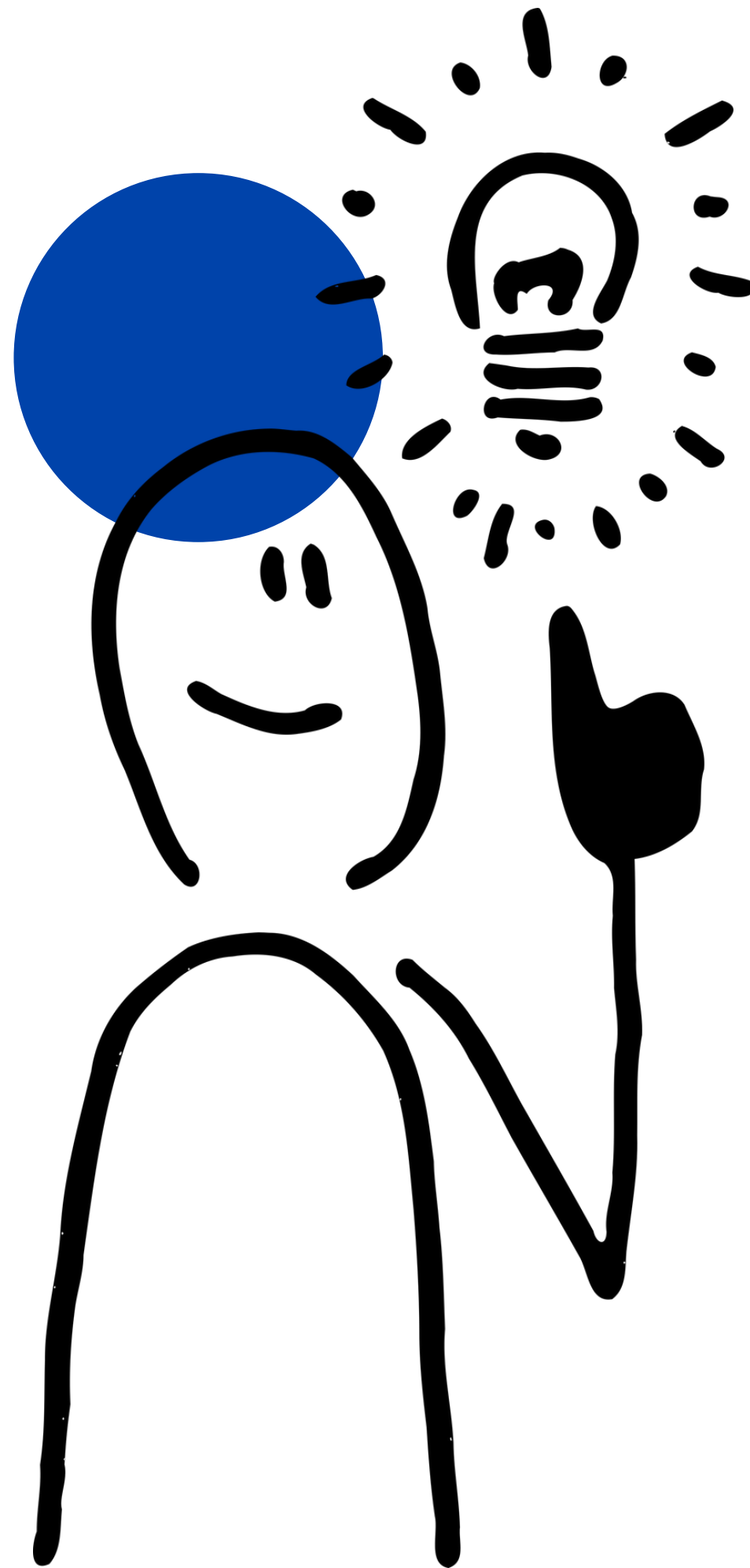
"The office hotline is never reachable. Every time, I have to physically go to the office just to check my case status or find out what documents are missing, and it's hard for me to walk."

- **Mr. Li (Case #344, TY2024-2025)**

"Everything is communicated by phone. Sometimes I don't understand, and sometimes I forget what documents I still need to bring by the time I get home. I wish they could text me instead — but even when they say they'll text, it often never comes, and I have to call again to follow up."

- **Ms. Liu (Case #512, TY2025)**

"My case was actually simple, but while I was waiting on-site, I noticed Case #526 got finished before mine. I don't know why, and I don't know how much longer I'll have to wait. When I asked, I was just told to wait a bit more."



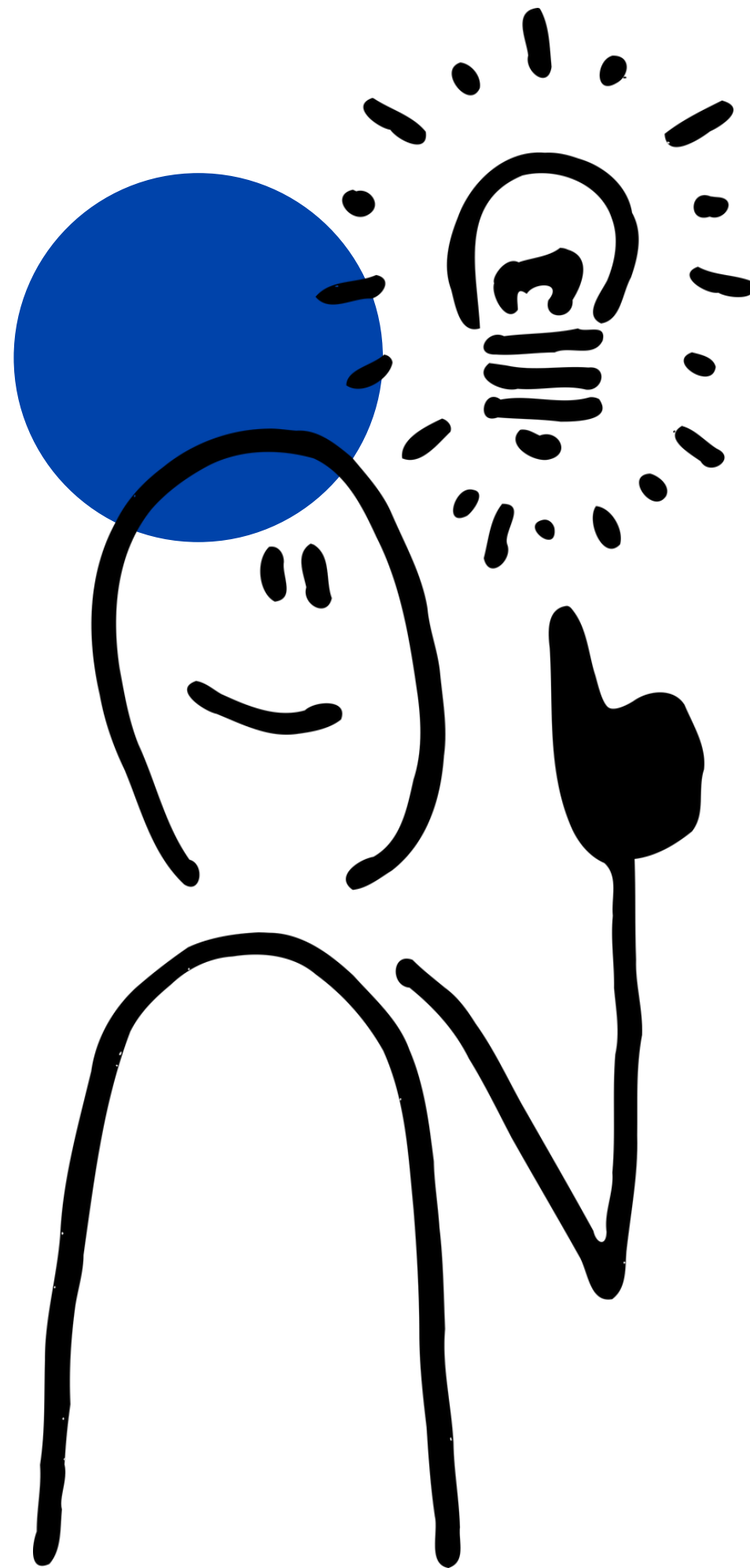
WHAT'S MORE...

- **Ms. Liu (TY2024, TY2025 Volunteer)**

"My schedule has always been flexible, but I happened to miss the workflow training session. Because of that, I didn't really understand the workflow for a long time — it took a while before I gradually figured it out. The admin team also didn't realize I was actually flexible until much later, so cases weren't assigned to me early on. I wish there was a more intuitive way to see what cases are available for me to take."

- **Roger (Volunteer, 20+ years with VITA, CPA / retired accountant)**

"Sometimes I see a lot of simple cases sitting there with no one working on them, so I just pick them up myself. Meanwhile, complex cases end up going to newer volunteers instead, who then keep coming to me with questions. Honestly, it would probably be more efficient if the complex cases were just assigned directly to me."



WHAT'S MORE...

- **Eunice (Site Coordinator, 2022-2023)**

"When we're at work trying to reach clients, they're usually at work too, so phone calls often don't go through. On top of that, clients tend not to trust voicemails or text messages from an unfamiliar number. Also, a lot of our clients don't know how to use Zoom, and many have mobility issues, which makes identity verification really difficult for them."

WHAT WE ARE GOING TO BUILD

MVP:

- 3 roles with permissions (Client, Volunteer, Admin)
- Bilingual Intake forms with accessibility and definitions of terms
- Auto generation of Form 13614-C and Form 14446, state machine of tax return process
- State machine

Final:

- In app communication with accountants
- Splitting volunteer into subcategories (IRS SPEC, Territory Manager, SPEC OPI Volunteer, Site Coordinator, VITA Volunteer, or Volunteer Instructor)
- Alert System
- AI assisted Customer Support

Explicitly Out:

- Facial Recognition, Live queue, Voice assistance, Scheduling
- Pre-season preparation



ViTally Team Roles

- **Front-End:**

- Hailey Zheng - UI Development; Intake Question Design
- Manqi Lu - UI Development; English-Chinese Translation
- Jinyu Yang - UI Development; Demo; Database

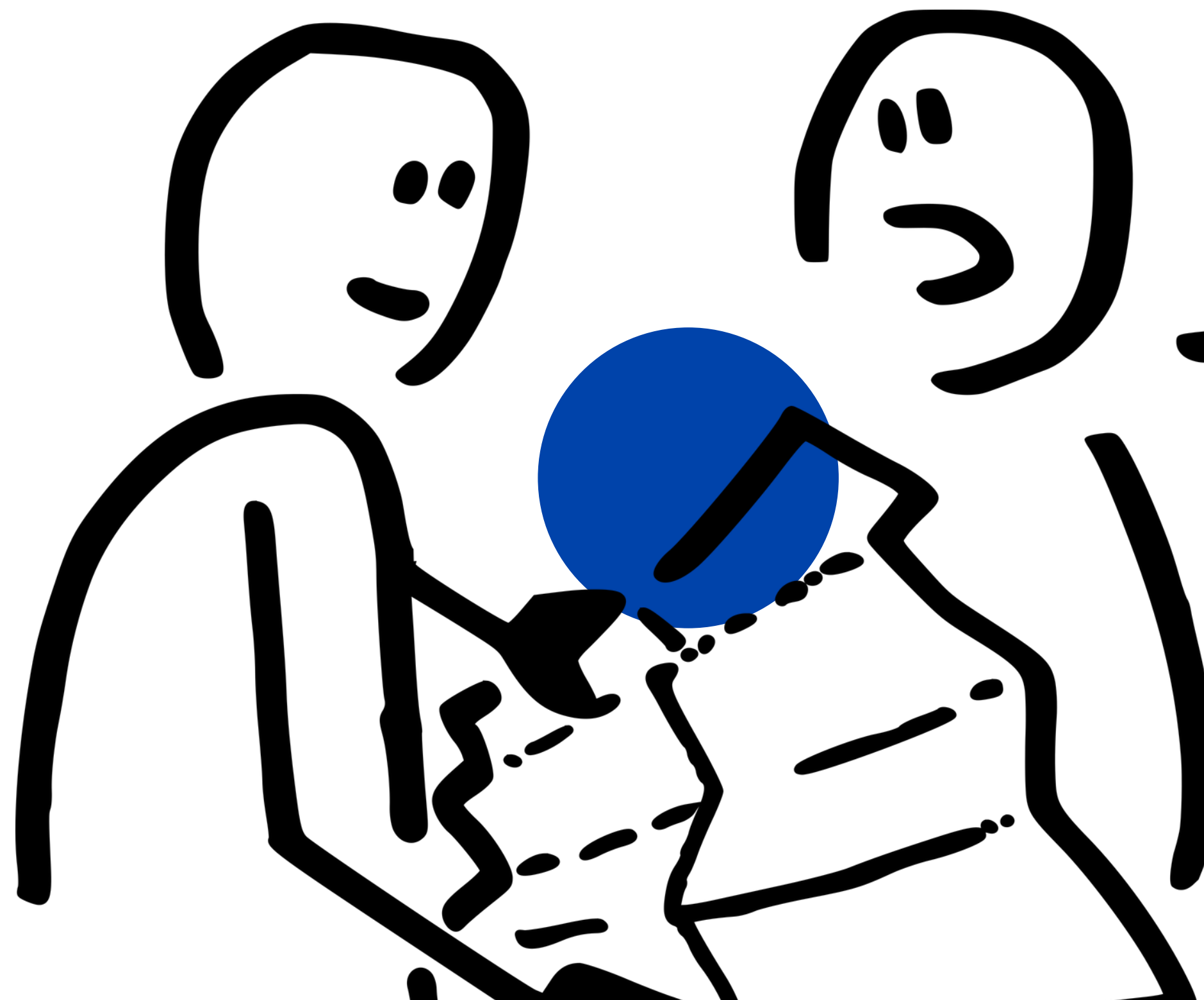
- **Back-End:**

- Cody Chi - Server-side Development
- Kelvin Chiu - Database Design and Development



DEMO

Jinyu



Thank You

